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Exam Hack of the Day

New Speaker = New Line

The Rule:

Every time a new person speaks, start a new line.

Never put two different speakers' dialogues in the same paragraph.

Why? 1) Avoids confusion about who is speaking.
2) It is the correct direct speech format expected by examiners.

WRONG

(both speakers in one paragraph)

Mrs. West cried, "Who dare touch my vase!" John replied, "I'm sorry, it was an accident." Mrs. West snapped, "You will pay for this!"

✗

CORRECT

(new line for each speaker)

Mrs. West cried, "Who dare touch my vase!" — speaker 1

"I'm sorry, it was an accident," John replied. — speaker 2

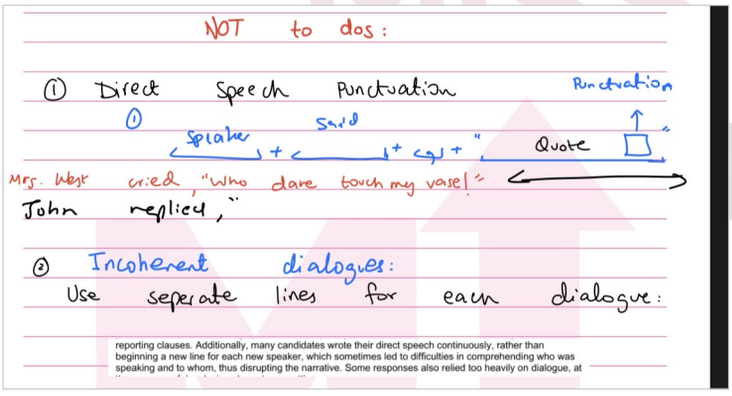
"You will pay for this!" Mrs. West snapped. — speaker 1

✓

Direct speech quick checklist:

- ✓ New speaker = new line (always)
- ✓ Punctuation goes INSIDE the quotation marks
- ✓ Reporting clause format: Speaker + said/cried/replied + , + "..."

From classroom notes:



NOTE: **Examiners specifically flag continuous dialogue as a common error. Separating speakers is one of the easiest marks to pick up.**